Background

- Let us assume that the blood pressure values were supposed to be collected each visit from weeks 1 to 5.
- For some reason, results were not collected at some visits.
- For analysis purposes, in some cases as seen in earlier lessons, we may be asked to use the last available result before a missing result instead of the missing result at that visit. We call this as 'Last observation carried forward' (LOCF).
- However, using the last available result can sometimes be too optimistic, especially if a patient left the study because the treatment was making them feel worse.
- To be more conservative, we use the Modified Baseline Observation Carried Forward (mBOCF) approach, which changes the imputation rule based on why the data is missing.
- If a subject discontinues due to Adverse Events (AEs), we carry forward the Baseline value to all subsequent missing visits instead of their last result.
- If a subject leaves for other reasons like a 'Protocol Violation', we stick to the standard Last Observation (LOCF).
- For intermittent missingness (a random gap while the patient is still on treatment), we also use the last non-missing result before that gap.

What is covered in this lesson

- In this lesson, we will see to programmatically handle mBOCF